

Ringworm - Male (Child)

Algorithm 1339 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Male

Definition

- Ringworm assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published ringworm guidance.
- Child patient.
- Male.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant or immunocompromised, where is the rash, and does it involve scalp, beard, nails, face, genitals, widespread skin, infection, household contacts, animals, or safeguarding concerns?
2. [DURATION] How long has it been present?
3. [YES_NO] Has it been treated with an antifungal already?
4. [CAREGIVER_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Impetigo (Infected Sore)

Is this mainly a weeping, blistered, or honey-crusted sore rather than a ring-shaped scaly rash?

A weeping or honey-crusted infected sore belongs in the Impetigo pathway.

1. Disposition level 70

Has the ringworm not improved after antifungal treatment recommended by a pharmacist, does it affect the scalp, or does the person have a weakened immune system (from chemotherapy, steroids, or diabetes)?

NHS.UK ringworm guidance recommends clinical review for these situations - scalp ringworm typically needs prescription treatment.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this a typical ring-shaped rash with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance recommends pharmacist-guided antifungal treatment as the first step for typical ringworm.

Advice

Ringworm needing clinical review

- Arrange a primary-care appointment for prescription-strength antifungal treatment.
- Call Back If: spreads rapidly; signs of secondary bacterial infection develop.

Governed ringworm care

- Keep the area clean/dry, avoid scratching and sharing towels, clothing, combs, or bedding, wash fabrics regularly, and consider affected household members/pets. Antifungal product, duration, scalp/nail treatment, pregnancy/breastfeeding, pediatric age, immunocompromise, and medicine interactions require approved Qatar pharmacist/clinician guidance. Do not use steroid cream alone on an undiagnosed fungal rash.
- Call Back If: scalp, beard, nail, widespread, painful, infected, or rapidly spreading involvement; no improvement or immunocompromised patient.

First aid

References

- NHS.UK, "Ringworm", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/ringworm/> (page last reviewed 03 August 2023)

Provenance

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